

CHRISTIAN JOHANSEN

Technical Lead · Full-Stack Software Engineer

Greenfield, MA · 413.244.5913 · cjohansen11@me.com · cjohansen.dev

SUMMARY

Full-stack engineer and technical lead with 6+ years of experience designing, shipping, and operating high-throughput web services. Currently leads the team that owns all real-time user communications, voice, video, SMS/MMS, and fax, at a healthcare company, with expertise in TypeScript, Node.js, NestJS, React, PostgreSQL, and distributed systems. Track record of mentoring engineers from mid-level through staff, driving cross-functional technical strategy, and turning complex architectural problems into reliable, measurable systems.

EXPERIENCE

Solace Health September 2023 – Present

Technical Lead, Communications Core (promoted from Software Engineer → Senior Software Engineer → Technical Lead)

- Lead the engineering team that owns every user-facing communication channel, voice calls, video calling, SMS/MMS, and faxing, across a NestJS/TypeScript backend serving healthcare providers and patients.
- Manage and mentor mid-level through staff engineers, run technical design reviews, and partner with fellow tech leads, the engineering director, and VP of Engineering on cross-core architecture and roadmap.
- Re-architected Twilio webhook handling to eliminate synchronous database work from the hot path: introduced CQRS-style read/write separation, Redis-backed read projections, and Bull queue offloading, materially cutting p95 webhook response times and reducing timeout-driven Twilio retries.
- Built the observability foundation for the communications stack in Datadog: APM span tagging across root and child spans, log-based metrics, custom dashboards for webhook health, and distributed trace correlation across separate HTTP requests via shared business identifiers.
- Hardened messaging pipelines end-to-end: fixed SMS routing bugs caused by dual user-lookup paths, added short-code detection with graceful fallback for Twilio's short-code sending limitation, and led a roadmap-level refactor of SMS reply handling.
- Authored internal standards adopted across engineering, including the staff engineer role definition (organized around "Cores") and demo testing plan ownership guidelines; wrote performance assessments for direct reports.
- Earlier at Solace: partnered with a cross-functional growth team to lift funnel conversion past 80%, turned Figma designs into reusable React component libraries, and integrated a new medication prescription API with the core backend.

bash.gg June 2022 – September 2023

Full-Stack Engineer

- Contributed to high-level engineering decisions on the design, infrastructure, and delivery of a React Native + Express application.
- Built 100+ RESTful endpoints and designed the PostgreSQL schema backing core product data.
- Managed AWS deployments and infrastructure-as-code via Terraform and GitHub Actions CI/CD.

Neon November 2021 – July 2022

Full-Stack Engineer

- Built RESTful endpoints in Node.js integrating Firebase, Sanity CMS, and the Solana network.
- Collaborated with designers to translate Figma into production React components.
- Implemented end-to-end data flow for NFT purchase, mint, and delivery using Circle payments and web3.js for Solana.

Moonfarmer October 2021 – December 2021

Software Engineer (Contract)

- Developed reusable React components in Storybook to accelerate delivery across multiple client projects.
- Wrote RESTful endpoints integrating with Strapi headless CMS.

Spectra Logic November 2015 – November 2018

Systems Support Technician

- Triageed incident tickets, analyzed logs, and delivered clear resolution summaries while maintaining high customer satisfaction.
- Mentored junior technicians through training sessions and side-by-side troubleshooting.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS

Backend: Node.js, NestJS, Express, REST APIs, CQRS, event-driven architecture, transactional outbox patterns

Frontend: React, React Native, Next.js, XState, Tailwind, shadcn/ui

Data: PostgreSQL, TypeORM, Prisma, Drizzle, Redis, Bull/BullMQ, Redis Streams

Communications: Twilio (Voice, Messaging, Conversations), Socket.IO, WebRTC concepts, fax integrations (Documo)

Observability: Datadog APM, log-based metrics, dd-trace, distributed tracing, custom dashboards

Infrastructure: Docker, AWS, Heroku, Terraform, GitHub Actions

Leadership: Team management, technical mentorship, cross-functional roadmap planning, performance reviews, technical writing

EDUCATION

Hack Reactor — Advanced Software Engineering

University of Massachusetts – Amherst — B.S. Psychology